

ON LOSSES OF ROYALTY

July 2, 2009

In Lok Sabha

The court case between RIL and RNRL is a commercial matter between two companies. As far as Government take, including royalty, is concerned it is governed by the PSC signed between the Government and the signatory to the PSC. Royalty is to be paid to the Government as per PSC provisions.

IN SPECIAL LEAVE PETITION

July 2, 2009

Knowing fully well that gas does not belong to them and that the contracting companies are bound by the terms of the PSC, the respondents have appropriated through the MoU, in a surreptitious and unauthorised manner, the entire gas treating the same as their personal and family property. The MoU, therefore, to the extent that it has as its consideration a property not belonging to the signatories to the MoU (in this case belonging to the Sovereign Government of India) is blatantly illegal and in disregard of provisions of the PSC and should be declared null & void. Such part of the MoU does not deserve to be given effect to.

IN REPLY FILED BEFORE SUPREME COURT

July 2, 2009

The Government has outlined its priorities for supply of gas and this cannot be held subject to a family arrangement between two parties as it would be against the sovereignty right of the Government.

MINISTERSPEAK

Are you against Anil Ambani?

I have no personal quarrel with Anil. Instead of making statements and counter statements, we should wait for the honourable Supreme Court to come to a decision.

There are allegations of bias.

We have nothing to do with the private dispute of two individuals. We have everything to do with protecting public interest.

Why did the Government intervene?

As a custodian of the national resources, I am concerned only about protecting what belongs to the people of India. I see it as my duty to ensure safety of sovereign assets.

PETROLEUM
MINISTER
MURLI DEORA

SHIPRA DAS

